

Key Tips for Shipping Furniture to Colombia

When shipping as a new resident (not a returning Colombian), your furniture is treated as a standard import. The total tax burden is calculated on the **CIF value (Cost of the goods + Insurance + Freight)**.

As a first-time resident on a retirement visa, you are not eligible for the household goods exemption. You will pay full import duties and taxes on your furniture.

IKEA Furniture, decoration, and inspiration in Cali, Colombia

https://www.ikea.com/co/es/?qclsrc=aw.ds&qad_source=1&qad_campaignid=20602348048&qbraid=0AAAAAp7dt--rTBL6AFmS-_ITptNVH9hc6&qclid=CjwKCAjwqubPBhBOEiwAzqZX2oigM1kAVnD9pRX2BXgagt9ccaVL09KStpv44fkc6CvIc3pbFN3fQhoC73YQAvD_BwE



Step-by-Step Process (Short Version) of Shipping Your Furniture

1. Choose your shipping method

- 20-ft container – Fits a 1-2 bedroom apartment
- 40-ft container – Fits a 3-4 bedroom house
- LCL (shared container) – Pay only for the space you use

2. Get quotes from 3+ movers

- Search: "International movers USA to Colombia."

3. Make a detailed inventory list

- Example: "Used wooden dining table, brown, 6 chairs"
- Vague descriptions cause delays and fines

4. Ship your furniture

- Pickup → Packing → Truck to US port → Ocean freight to Colombia → Customs → Delivery to Cali

5. Hire a Colombian customs broker (mandatory)

- Your moving company usually has a partner agent

6. Pay taxes before release

- Your broker tells you the amount due

7. Receive delivery in Cali

Import Taxes and Fees

Here is a breakdown of the main costs you will face.

Tax/Fee Name	Standard Rate	Calculated On	Notes
Ad Valorem Duty (Arancel)	10% - 20% for furniture	CIF Value	This is the core import tariff. The average rate is around 11.31%, but finished consumer goods, such as furniture, are at the higher end.
Value Added Tax (IVA)	19%	CIF Value + Duty Amount	This is a universal sales tax applied to almost all imports.
Customs Broker/Agent Fees	~ 300–600+	N/A	A professional fee for the licensed Colombian agency that processes your customs declaration.

Port & Handling Fees	Variable (200–500+)	N/A	These are terminal handling charges, document fees, and other administrative costs at the port.
De Minimis Threshold	\$200 USD	Shipment Value	In 2026, the old 200 tax exemption for value personal shipments been reduced to 200 tax exemption for value personal shipment. been reduced to 50 USD for commerce purchases, but for general cargo, exceeding this amount triggers the full 10% import taxes.

Cost Comparison for Furniture Valued at 5,000,10,000, and \$15,000

The following table provides an estimated tax calculation for your furniture's value. It does not include ocean freight costs (see below). **It assumes a 20% Ad Valorem Duty as a conservative estimate for furniture.**

Furniture Cost Component	Shipment Value: \$5,000 USD	Shipment Value: \$10,000 USD	Shipment Value: \$15,000 USD
Estimated Ocean Freight (20-ft container)	+ \$2,500	+ \$2,500	+ \$2,500
Estimated Insurance (~3% of value)	+ \$150	+ \$300	+ \$450
CIF Value (Customs base)	\$7,650	\$12,800	\$17,950

Ad Valorem Duty (20%)	\$1,530	\$2,560	\$3,590
Value for IVA Tax (CIF + Duty)	\$9,180	\$15,360	\$21,540
IVA Tax (19%)	\$1,744	\$2,918	\$4,093
Estimated Customs Broker/Port Fees	+ \$600	+ \$600	+ \$600
TOTAL ESTIMATED COST TO SHIP	~\$6,524	~\$8,878	~\$11,233

This is a simplified estimate. The final duty rate can vary based on the specific type of wood, upholstery, or antique status of your furniture.

Hyperlinks for Further Research

- **DIAN (Colombian Tax and Customs Authority):** The official source for all customs regulations. Use Google Translate to navigate the site.
 - Direct Link: <https://www.dian.gov.co>
 - *Note: This is a large, secure government portal. It may load more slowly than commercial sites.*
- **U.S. Commercial Service - Colombia:** Provides detailed guides on import regulations and taxes for businesses and individuals.
 - Corrected Direct Link: <https://www.trade.gov/colombia>
- **International Association of Movers (IAM):** A directory to find verified and reputable international moving companies.
 - Direct Link: <https://iamovers.org>
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Here are 3 American companies that can help you ship your furniture from the United States to Colombia.

American Companies for Shipping to Colombia

1. Schumacher Cargo Logistics

U.S. Locations: Los Angeles, Houston, Savannah, Miami, New York, New Jersey

A US-based international mover with over 40 years of experience. They offer full-service door-to-door shipping, including packing, export documentation, customs clearance, and final delivery to your home in Cali.

Detail	Information
Services	Full container (FCL), shared container (LCL), professional packing, storage, customs documentation
Phone	Call via the website for a quote
Website	www.schumachercargo.com
Average Cost: 3,000–6,000 for a 20-ft container to Colombia	

2. SDC International Shipping

U.S. Locations: U.S.-based international mover (contact for specific locations)

SDC has over a decade of experience shipping household goods to Colombia. They offer both ocean and air freight options with dedicated move coordinators. They specialize in helping expats avoid common customs delays.

Detail	Information
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Services	Door-to-door, port-to-port, packing, insurance, customs documentation
Phone	877-339-0267
Website	www.sdcinternationalshipping.com
Average Cost: 2,500–5,500 for ocean freight (20-ft container)	

3. Latin American Cargo (LAC)

U.S. Locations: Multiple U.S. hubs (contact for specific cities)

LAC has 25+ years of specialized experience shipping freight to Colombia from the USA and Canada. They coordinate with local Colombian partners for customs clearance and final delivery.

Detail	Information
Services	Ocean freight, air freight, customs brokerage, and inland trucking in Colombia
Phone	Contact via website
Website	www.latinamericancargo.com
Average Cost: 2,800–5,000 for full container (20-ft)	

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Requirement	Details
Documentation	Passport, visa, detailed inventory list (in Spanish), bill of lading
Prohibited Items	Firearms, illegal drugs, certain chemicals, and hazardous materials
Transit Time	3 to 6 weeks for ocean freight
Customs Note	First-time residents typically pay duties (~15-20% + 19% IVA)

Additional Options (From Search Results)

While not part of the main 4, these also appear in the search results and may be worth contacting:

Company	Location	Direct Link
Cargo Compass Colombia SAS	Bogotá	https://www.wcaworld.com/directory/members/76777
Agencia de Aduanas Andinos	Colombia	https://www.andinossas.com/servicios-especiales
John Mason International	UK-based, ships to Colombia	https://johnmason.com/international-removals/central-and-south-america/colombia/

Before contacting these companies, be aware of a key requirement: to import a household goods shipment to Colombia, you must have a visa valid for more than one year. Your M-11 Pensionado Visa qualifies, but ensure your visa is approved before shipping. Also, note that as a first-time resident (not a returning Colombian citizen), you will likely need to pay duties and taxes of approximately 15% on the CIF value (Cost, Insurance, and Freight) of your shipment.

Contact List for Shipping Companies

1. Schumacher Cargo Logistics

- Toll-Free Number: 800-599-0190 (Recommended for quotes)
- California Office (Long Beach): 1-562-408-6677
- California Office (Hayward/San Francisco): (510) 995-9595
- Texas Office (Houston): (713) 592-5580

2. SDC International Shipping

- Toll-Free Number: 877-339-0267 (Primary contact for quotes and customer service)
- California Office: (818) 390-9504

3. Latin American Cargo (LAC)

- Main Number: +1 514-735-7038
 - *Note: While their contact number is based in Canada, they are a North American company specializing in shipping to Latin America, including Colombia.*

Email Letter Template: Request for Quote

Subject: Quote Request: Household Goods Shipment from USA to Cali, Colombia

To: [Company Sales Email – find on their website]

Dear Shipping Team,

I am relocating to Cali, Colombia, on a retirement visa and need to ship my household goods (furniture and personal effects) from the United States.

Please provide a door-to-door quote for the following shipment:

Item	Details
Origin (Pickup) City & Zip Code	[City, State, Zip Code, e.g., Miami, FL 33101]
Destination City	Cali, Colombia (near Chipichape Mall)
Shipment Value (for insurance)	[\$5,000 / 10,000 / 15,000] USD
Estimated Shipment Volume	[e.g., 1-bedroom apartment (20-ft container) OR just a few boxes (<5 cubic meters)]
Preferred Shipping Method	[Ocean Freight / Air Freight / Not sure - please advise]
Desired Service Type	Door-to-Door (including customs clearance and delivery to my apartment in Cali)

Please include the following in your quote:

1. Base shipping cost (ocean or air freight)
2. Estimated customs brokerage fees in Colombia
3. Insurance cost (based on the declared value)
4. Estimated timeline from pickup to delivery in Cali

A few notes about my situation:

- I will be moving with a valid M-11 Pensionado Visa (Colombian retirement visa).
- I understand that as a new resident (not a returning Colombian citizen), I will likely need to pay import duties and 19% IVA tax upon arrival.
- All furniture is used and for personal use only.

Please let me know what additional documents you need from me to provide an accurate quote.

Thank you for your assistance.

Sincerely,

[Your Full Name]

Phone (USA): [Your U.S. phone number]

Email: [Your email address]

Best Time to Contact: [Morning / Afternoon / Anytime]